American Express Company

AXP | New York Stock Exchange

USD 325.50 per share

Closing price, Tuesday 3 November 2026, latest completed trading day



AXP daily closing price, 3 August to 3 November 2026 (63 trading days), USD per share. Source: Alpha Vantage daily price series, NYSE.

REPORT DATE
4 November 2026

ANALYST
Arthur Faugeron

SERIES
Financial

EXCHANGE
New York Stock Exchange

Executive Summary

American Express is a closed-loop payments network that also lends to its own card members, so it earns three kinds of income at once: fees on spending, net interest on balances and annual card fees. At USD 325.50 the shares trade at 18.4 times trailing earnings, in line with their own five-year average of 18.4 times, after a 12.0% fall from its December 2025 month-end high.

Business

American Express generated USD 72.2bn of total revenues net of interest expense in FY2025 on USD 1,670bn of billed business and 86.6 million proprietary cards. Revenue comes from discount revenue on spending, net card fees of about USD 10bn, and net interest income on card member loans, with 41% of billed business from small business and corporate clients and the United States contributing 77% of regional revenue.

Financial Condition

FY2025 net income was USD 10.8bn (diluted EPS USD 15.38, up 10%), free cash flow was USD 16.0bn, and return on equity was 34.0%. The balance sheet is a lender's: USD 300.1bn of assets funded by USD 152.5bn of deposits, USD 63.9bn of debt and USD 33.5bn of equity, so net debt to EBITDA is not a meaningful measure here.

Market Position

The main competitors are Visa, Mastercard, Capital One with Discover, and large issuing banks such as JPMorgan Chase and Citigroup. The advantage is a closed-loop data and merchant-pricing position that supports premium fees; the weakness is scale, since the 10-K describes American Express as the fourth largest general-purpose card network, and a 13% billed-business dependence on the Delta co-brand.

Valuation

Market capitalization is USD 218.3bn and the provider-quoted enterprise value is USD 234.8bn, though enterprise value is of limited use for a lender. The stock trades at 18.4 times trailing GAAP earnings, 18.3 times the midpoint of adjusted FY2026 guidance, 15.7 times trailing free cash flow and 6.0 times book value.

KEY FIGURES AT A GLANCE, USD

Metric	Value	Metric	Value
Share price, 3 November 2026	325.50	Diluted EPS, FY2025	15.38
Market capitalization	218.3bn	Free cash flow, FY2025	16.0bn
Revenue net of interest expense, FY2025	72.2bn	Return on equity, FY2025	34.0%
Net income, FY2025	10.8bn	Price to earnings, trailing	18.4x

Source: American Express Form 8-K January 2026; StockAnalysis.com; Alpha Vantage. Multiples calculated at the 3 November 2026 close.

Investment Framework

WHAT IS ATTRACTIVE	Revenue grew 10% in FY2025 and 9% in the third quarter of 2026, return on equity held between 31.7% and 35.7% for five years, and the diluted share count fell about 3% a year.
WHAT IS CONCERNING	The stock is down 9.8% over twelve months against 11.1% total return for the S&P 500 ETF, and a third-quarter reserve release flattered earnings.
WHAT MUST GO RIGHT	Billed business growth of 7% to 9%, a write-off rate near 2%, and card fees that outpace rewards and marketing costs.
WHAT COULD BREAK THE THESIS	Legislation on card routing or interest rates, a premium consumer credit downturn, or weaker Delta partnership economics.
PRICED IN	The base equity cash-flow value is USD 273 per share at a 10.0% cost of equity; the price implies a cost of equity near 8.9% or 13% annual earnings growth. Reasonable to optimistic.

Investment Profile

ASSESSMENT BY DIMENSION

Dimension	Assessment
Business quality	High. Fee income of about USD 10bn a year and a premium customer base lift returns well above lenders without a network.
Financial quality	High. Return on equity of 34.0% and free cash flow 1.5 times net income in FY2025, though cash flow for a lender is distorted by credit provisions.
Competitive position	Strong but narrow. Closed-loop data and merchant relationships are hard to copy; scale is a fraction of the open-loop networks.
Growth profile	Moderate and steady. Guidance is about 10% revenue growth for FY2026 and EPS has compounded at 11.3% a year since FY2021.
Balance-sheet risk	Moderate. Assets are 9.0 times equity, deposits fund 97% of loans, and credit losses are the key swing factor.
Valuation	Fair to full. Close to the own five-year average multiple, a premium to Capital One and a large discount to Visa and Mastercard.
Market and technical profile	Neutral. Price is above the 50-day average and just below the 200-day average, with 12.0% drawdown from the high.

Source: analyst assessment based on the data in sections A to C.

A. About the Business

A1. Business Environment

The industry is consumer and commercial payments: moving money from a buyer to a seller, and extending short-term credit on the way. The value chain has five layers. Merchants accept cards, acquirers and processors connect them to networks, networks set rules and route authorizations, issuers hold the customer relationship and credit risk, and customers pay with cash, balances or revolving credit.

Revenue pools are discount or interchange fees on spending, net interest on revolving balances, annual fees, and foreign exchange and servicing charges. Cost pools are rewards, marketing, credit losses, funding and technology.

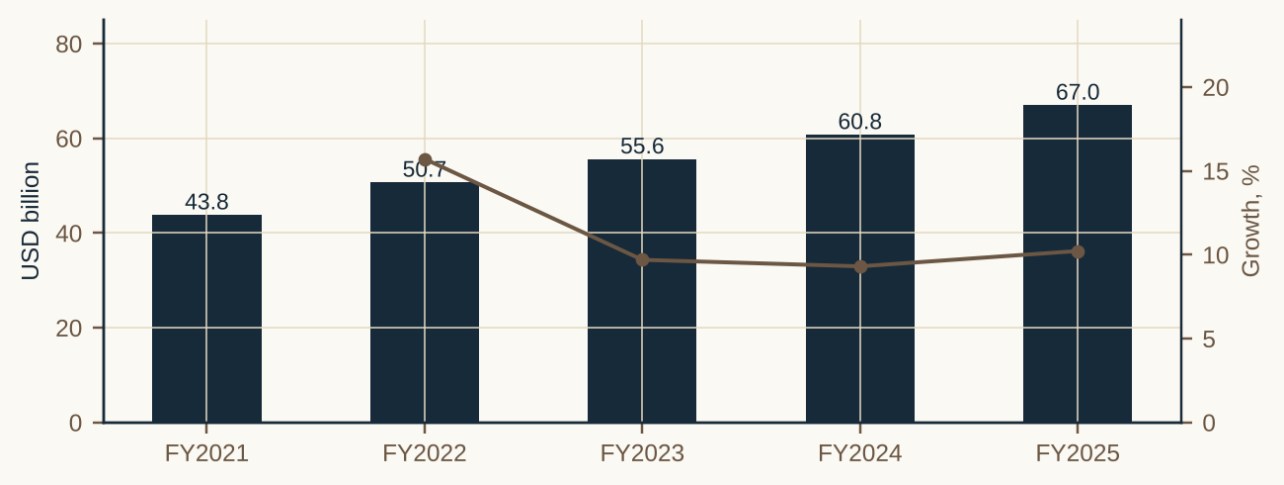
Economics differ sharply by role. Pure networks such as Visa and Mastercard carry no credit risk and report operating margins of 66.3% and 60.1% on a trailing basis. Issuers earn lower margins because they bear credit losses and funding costs. American

Express sits in both layers, so it earns network economics on its own spending base and issuer economics on its loans. Capital intensity is low for networks and high for lenders, since loans of USD 156.5bn need equity and funding.

Demand is cyclical because spending and credit quality follow employment and consumer confidence. Regulation is heavy: capital rules set a minimum common equity tier 1 ratio of 7.0% for the company including a 2.5% stress capital buffer, and interchange, interest rates and routing all attract legislative attention. The structure is concentrated at the network layer and fragmented among issuers. Technology dependence is high, with real-time payments, tokenized wallets and fraud analytics all changing how value is captured.

Stage: mature with structural growth. Card penetration of total payments still rises as cash declines, which supports mid to high single-digit volume growth, but the pools are already large. Consolidation, for example the combination of Capital One and Discover, and technological change in payment rails make the industry structurally transforming rather than static.

Net revenue after credit provisions and annual growth, FY2021 to FY2025



Source: StockAnalysis.com annual income statement (reported revenue net of interest expense less provisions for credit losses), accessed 4 November 2026.
Units: USD billion; growth in percent.

INDUSTRY STAGE: MATURE, WITH STRUCTURAL GROWTH IN CARD PENETRATION

> Growth is driven by the shift from cash to cards and by premium and commercial spending, while pricing power is capped by regulation and competition. The reasons for the mature label are scale (USD 1,670bn of billed business at American Express alone), saturated card ownership in developed markets and low single-digit unit growth in cash replacement. What could reverse the trend is a regulated cut to interchange or interest, or a credit downturn.

A2. What Does the Company Do?

American Express issues charge and credit cards, runs its own payment network, and signs merchants to accept those cards. For a new employee the simplest description is that the company sells three products to one customer base: spending convenience to consumers and businesses, acceptance and data to merchants, and credit to members who choose to borrow. Because the company is both issuer and network, it sees both sides of each transaction and can set merchant pricing, rewards and credit limits with that information.

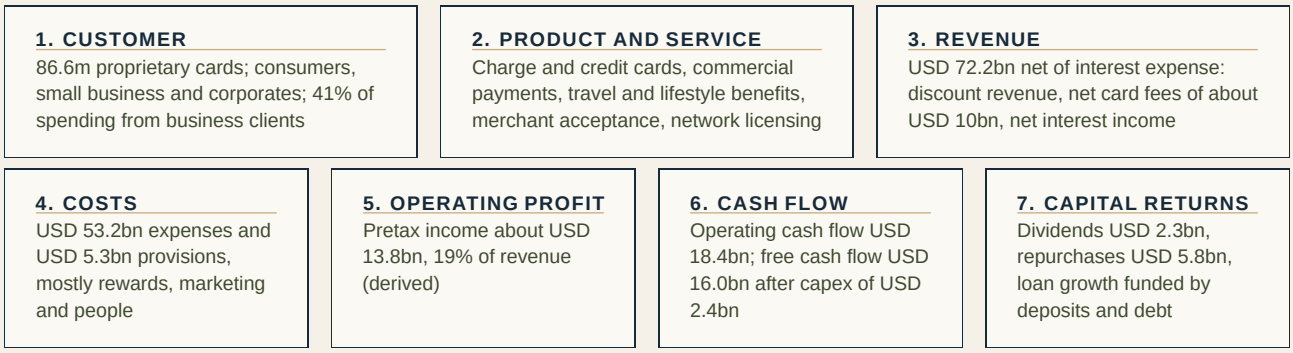
The company reports four segments. U.S. Consumer Services issues cards to American consumers and small businesses. Commercial Services serves small and mid-sized businesses and corporates with cards and payments. International Card Services issues outside the United States. Global Merchant and Network Services signs merchants, runs the network and licenses third-party issuers, which accounted for 66.2 million third-party cards in force at year-end 2025 and processed volume of USD 227.2bn. The company had about 76,800 employees at the end of 2025.

Revenue is a mix of recurring and spending-linked items. Annual card fees of about USD 10bn are recurring and prepaid, discount revenue follows billed business of USD 1,670bn, and net interest income follows loans of USD 156.5bn. Pricing is set by merchant discount rates, card fee schedules and interest rates.

The Delta co-brand shows the scale of partner economics: it represented about 13% of worldwide billed business and about 21% of worldwide card member loans at year-end 2025. Small business and corporate clients represented about 41% of FY2025 billed business.

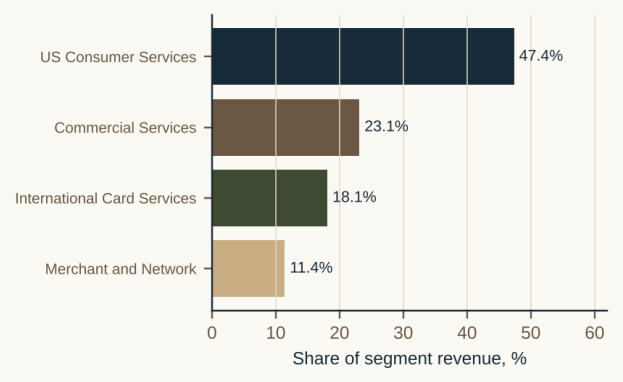
How one dollar of revenue is used

Of every dollar of FY2025 revenue net of interest expense (USD 72.2bn), about 7 cents went to credit provisions (USD 5.3bn), about 74 cents to operating expenses and rewards (total expenses USD 53.2bn), leaving about 19 cents of pretax income (USD 13.8bn, derived). After tax at 21.5%, about 15 cents became net income. The largest cost lines are card member rewards, marketing and compensation; a split by line was not retrieved.



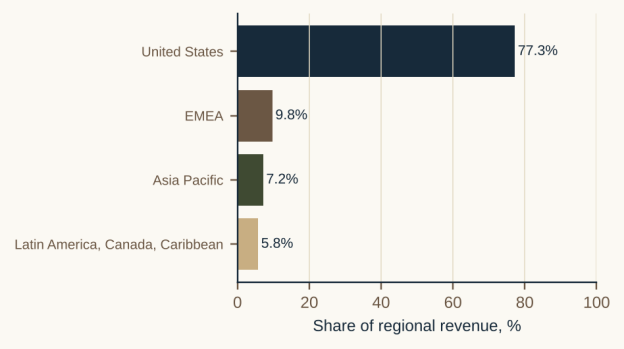
The economically critical pieces are annual fees and the spending base, because they are high-margin and recurring, and the credit loss line, because a one-point move in the write-off rate on USD 156.5bn of loans is worth roughly USD 1.6bn of pretax income.

Revenue by segment, FY2025



Source: MarketScreener segment data, FY2025. Share of segment revenue after provisions (total USD 67.0bn).

Revenue by region, FY2025



Source: MarketScreener geographic data, FY2025. Share of the four regions' revenue (USD 72.5bn before unallocated items of minus USD 0.3bn).

A3. Business and Relationship Network

ECOSYSTEM MAP

Node	Relationship	Why it matters economically
Card members	86.6m proprietary cards; consumers, small business, corporates	Source of discount revenue, fees and interest; mix is premium and affluent
Merchants	Accept the card under American Express pricing and rules	Merchant discount rate funds rewards; acceptance gaps are a competitive risk
Delta Air Lines	Largest co-brand partner	About 13% of billed business and 21% of loans; partner terms shape returns
Third-party issuers	66.2m third-party cards and USD 227.2bn processed volume	Network revenue with little credit risk
Deposit funding	Bank subsidiary and direct deposits of USD 152.5bn	Cheaper, more stable funding than unsecured debt
Debt investors	USD 63.9bn total debt	Sets the marginal funding cost, sensitive to the 5.13% ten-year yield
Global Business Travel Group (GBTG)	Equity stake sold in the third quarter of 2026	Produced a pretax gain of USD 982m, excluded from adjusted earnings
Regulators	Federal Reserve capital rules, consumer finance and payments regulators	Set the 7.0% minimum CET1 requirement and the limits on pricing
Competing networks and issuers	Visa, Mastercard, JCB, UnionPay, Discover, issuing banks	Compete for customers, merchants and talent

Source: American Express Form 10-K FY2025; Form 8-K third quarter 2026; MarketScreener; StockAnalysis.com balance sheet. Other co-brand partners were not itemized in the retrieved material.

A4. Competition

COMPETITIVE COMPARISON, USD

Company	Mkt cap, bn	P/E	Fwd P/E	ROE	Beta	Net margin
American Express	218.3	18.4x	16.3x	35.9%	1.08	15.8%
Visa	769.1	33.6x	27.5x	63.5%	0.77	51.2%
Mastercard	555.8	33.4x	28.7x	231.4%	0.76	46.7%
Capital One	121.8	12.0x	8.8x	9.4%	1.04	22.2%

Source: StockAnalysis.com statistics pages, Visa 31 October, Mastercard 1 November, Capital One 27 October, American Express 26 October 2026 (market capitalization recomputed at the 3 November close of USD 325.50 on 670.55m shares). American Express net margin is calculated as trailing net income over trailing total revenue net of interest expense; peers are as published. Mastercard return on equity is inflated by a very small equity base.

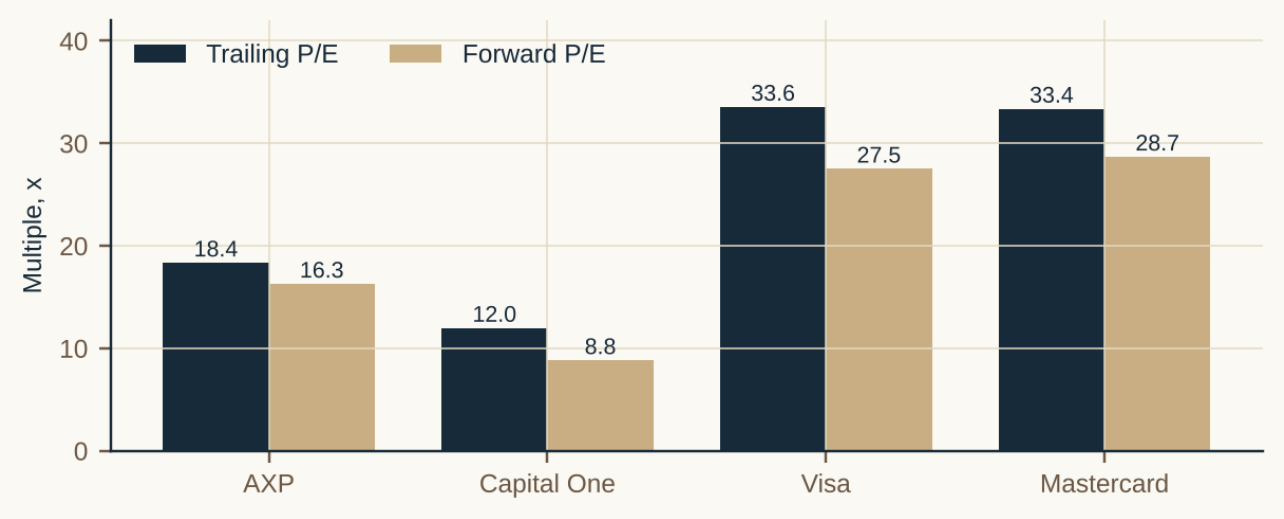
Visa and Mastercard are the direct network competitors. They sell open-loop acceptance to issuing banks, take no credit risk, and earn net margins of about 47% to 51%, but they do not own the customer or set merchant pricing, and American Express is the smaller network. Capital One, which has combined with Discover, competes as both a premium and mass-market issuer and now operates its own network.

JPMorgan Chase and Citigroup compete for affluent cardholders with large rewards programs funded by wider banking relationships.

Indirect competitors and substitutes include debit and bank transfers, mobile wallets and pay-by-bank schemes, plus regional systems such as China UnionPay, JCB and the National Payments Corporation of India named in the 10-K. Emerging competitors are real-time payment rails and buy-now-pay-later providers.

Peers were chosen because they compete for the same affluent spenders, merchants and talent: Visa and Mastercard for the network role, and Capital One for the combined issuer and network role. Relative to peers, American Express earns a higher return on equity than any lender here, a lower valuation than the pure networks, and a premium to Capital One that reflects its fee model and higher returns.

Trailing and forward price to earnings, American Express and peers



Source: StockAnalysis.com statistics pages, 26 October to 1 November 2026; American Express trailing multiple at the 3 November close. Units: multiple of earnings.

A5. Competitive Differences

Advantages. The closed-loop structure gives American Express transaction-level data on both cardholder and merchant, which supports targeted offers and credit decisions. Brand and premium positioning allow annual fees of about USD 10bn, a revenue stream that open networks do not capture. Customer relationships are sticky, since benefits and points balances raise switching costs.

The funding side is strong: deposits of USD 152.5bn cover 97% of loans. These advantages show up in numbers: return on equity of 34.0% in FY2025 and a pretax margin near 21% on net revenue after provisions.

Disadvantages. Acceptance is narrower than Visa and Mastercard, a gap the 10-K notes by describing the company as the fourth largest general-purpose network. Merchant discount rates are higher, which invites surcharging and merchant litigation, both listed in the 10-K as risks. Credit exposure is real: loans of USD 156.5bn would absorb a rise in the write-off rate above 2.0%. Partner concentration is notable, with Delta at 13% of billed business and 21% of loans. Rewards inflation across competitors raises costs.

Structural versus temporary. Brand, data and network design are structural. Fee pricing power and credit performance are cyclical and partly temporary: a 1.8% write-off rate and a reserve release in the third quarter of 2026 are favorable conditions, not permanent features.

MOAT ASSESSMENT: MODERATE TO STRONG

> The moat rests on a premium customer base, closed-loop data and sticky benefits, and is evidenced by five years of return on equity between 31.7% and 35.7%. It is not Very Strong because the network is smaller than its two main rivals, margins are exposed to rewards competition, and regulators can reshape merchant pricing.

A6. Industry Trend

Historical growth has been strong. American Express billed business grew 8% in FY2025 to USD 1,669.8bn (7% adjusted for currency) and 9% in the first nine months of 2026 to USD 1,337.7bn, so card spending is compounding at a high single-digit rate. Demand drivers are the shift from cash to cards, premium and commercial spending, and travel.

Supply drivers are the rewards arms race, new issuer entrants and network consolidation. Pricing is stable for annual fees, which keep rising, while merchant fees are under pressure from legislation and surcharging.

Structural trends: digitization of payments, tokenized wallets, real-time payment rails, commercial payments automation and growing regulation of fees. Temporary conditions: the favorable credit cycle, the third-quarter reserve release, and strong high-income consumer spending. The stage is mature with structural growth, partly cyclical through credit. The trend would reverse if unemployment rises sharply, if routing and interest-rate legislation passes, or if a rival network takes premium spending share.

A7. Management

The chief executive has held the role for nearly nine years, and the February 2025 reshuffle of three group presidents suggests planned succession depth.

Capital allocation has been disciplined: shares outstanding fell from 761 million at year-end 2021 to 686 million at year-end 2025 (about 2.6% a year), the quarterly dividend rose about 16% from USD 0.82 to USD 0.95 in 2026, and total shareholder returns were USD 7.6bn in FY2025 per the annual report (USD 8.1bn on the cash flow statement).

Dividends per share rose from USD 1.72 to USD 3.28 over four years, a 17.5% annual rate, while the payout ratio stayed near 21%. Guidance is credible but cautious: the initial FY2026 EPS range of USD 17.30 to 17.90 was narrowed upward on adjusted

earnings to USD 17.60 to 17.90 with the third quarter. The USD 336m restructuring charge in the third quarter of 2026 is a one-off that deserves watching for recurrence.

Alignment with shareholders appears good on payout, though compensation and insider ownership details were not retrieved.

EXECUTIVE TEAM

Name	Position	Tenure in role and age
Stephen J. Squeri	Chairman and Chief Executive Officer	Since February 2018, age 66
Christophe Y. Le Caillec	Chief Financial Officer	Since August 2023, age 60
Douglas E. Buckminster	Vice Chairman	Since April 2021, age 65
Howard Grosfield	Group President, U.S. Consumer Services	Since February 2025, age 57
Raymond Joabar	Group President, Global Commercial Services	Since February 2025, age 60
Anna Marrs	Group President, Global Merchant and Network Services	Since February 2025, age 52
Rafael Marquez	President, International Card Services	Since May 2022, age 54
Douglas Tabish	Chief Risk Officer	Since April 2024, age 56

Source: American Express Form 10-K FY2025, executive officers. Earlier career history and insider ownership percentages were not retrieved.

B. Evaluation

B1. Financial and Operating Metrics

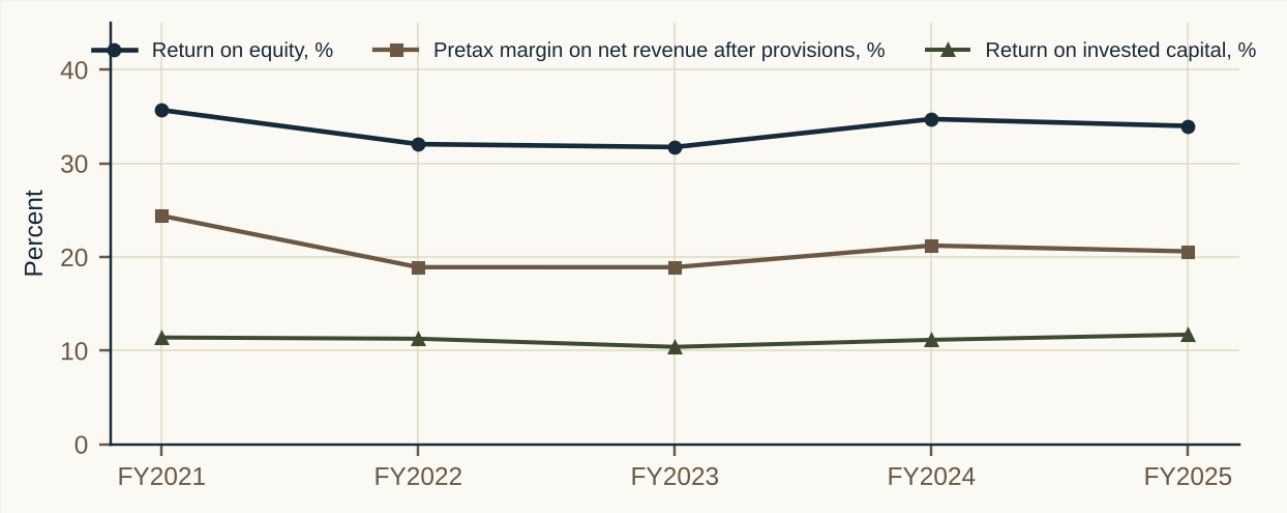
Return on equity near 34% is high because the company runs assets at 9.0 times equity, not because margins are unusually wide. Return on invested capital of about 11.7% is a more sober measure of value creation and compares with a cost of equity near 10%, a positive but modest spread. Pretax margin stepped down from 24.4% in FY2021, when credit reserves were released, to a stable 19% to 21% since FY2022.

PROFITABILITY AND RETURNS

Metric	FY2021	FY2022	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025
Pretax margin on net revenue after provisions	24.4%	18.9%	18.9%	21.2%	20.6%
Net margin to common on net revenue after provisions	18.1%	14.6%	14.8%	16.4%	16.0%
Return on equity	35.7%	32.1%	31.7%	34.7%	34.0%
Return on assets	4.2%	3.6%	3.4%	3.8%	3.8%
Return on invested capital	11.4%	11.3%	10.4%	11.2%	11.7%
Dividend payout ratio	18.0%	20.8%	21.3%	19.7%	21.0%

Source: StockAnalysis.com annual ratios and income statement, accessed 4 November 2026. Margins are calculated from provider revenue after provisions and derived pretax income; returns are provider-calculated. Gross and EBITDA margins are not meaningful for a card issuer because interest is an operating cost.

Return on equity, return on invested capital and pretax margin, FY2021 to FY2025



Source: StockAnalysis.com annual ratios; pretax margin calculated. Units: percent.

GROWTH, EFFICIENCY, LEVERAGE AND CASH FLOW METRICS

Metric	Value	Basis
Net revenue after provisions CAGR, FY2021 to FY2025	11.2%	Calculated
Diluted EPS CAGR, FY2021 to FY2025	11.3%	Calculated from reported EPS
Net income to common CAGR	7.8%	Calculated
Operating cash flow CAGR	5.9%	Calculated
Free cash flow CAGR	5.3%	Calculated
Diluted share count change per year	minus 3.1%	Calculated
Revenue to total assets, FY2025	0.24x	Calculated
Assets to equity, FY2025	9.0x	Calculated
Total debt to equity, FY2025	1.91x	Calculated
Deposits to loans, FY2025	97%	Calculated
Net write-off rate, FY2025 (principal only)	2.0%	Reported
Free cash flow margin, FY2025	22.2%	Calculated on total revenue
Free cash flow to net income, FY2025	1.50x	Calculated
Capex to revenue, FY2025 and trailing twelve months	3.4% and 4.8%	Calculated

Source: StockAnalysis.com; American Express Form 8-K January 2026. Inventory and receivables turnover are not applicable to a card issuer; card member receivables are managed through the write-off rate. Debt to EBITDA and interest coverage are not meaningful because funding cost is the main operating expense.

Earnings per share has grown faster than net income because buybacks cut the diluted share count from 790 million to 696 million. Net income to common grew 7.8% a year; EPS grew 11.3%. This is real value to remaining holders but it also means business growth, about 11% in net revenue after provisions, is the cleaner measure of expansion. Free cash flow grew only 5.3% a year and is volatile, with USD 19.2bn in FY2022 and USD 12.1bn in FY2024, because it includes swings in receivables and provisions.

B2. Risks

RISK REGISTER RANKED BY PROBABILITY TIMES IMPACT

Rank	Risk	Probability	Impact	Description
1	Credit cycle	Medium	High	Loans of USD 156.5bn grew 9.4%; the write-off rate was 2.0% in FY2025 and a reserve release helped the third quarter of 2026
2	Regulation of fees and rates	Medium	High	Routing, interchange and interest-rate legislation could cut merchant and lending income
3	Rewards and premium competition	High	Medium	Rival issuers fund richer rewards; expenses rose 11% against revenue up 10% in FY2025
4	Partner concentration	Medium	Medium	Delta is 13% of billed business and 21% of loans
5	Interest rates and funding	Medium	Medium	Ten-year yield at 5.13% in October 2026 against 4.14% in December 2025 raises funding cost
6	Valuation compression	Medium	Medium	18.4x earnings sits at the five-year mean, with a base cash-flow value below the price
7	Technology and payment rails	Low	Medium	Wallets, real-time payments and stablecoin-type rails could weaken the card model
8	Cyber, operations and legal	Low	Medium	Merchant litigation and surcharging are flagged in the 10-K
9	Currency and geography	Medium	Low	23% of revenue is outside the United States

Source: analyst assessment using American Express Form 10-K FY2025, Form 8-K third quarter 2026 and StockAnalysis.com data.

The three risks most capable of permanently impairing shareholder value are, first, adverse legislation that structurally lowers merchant or lending revenue, because it changes the model rather than the cycle. Second, a deep consumer credit downturn

at the premium end that raises write-offs well above 2% on a loan book that has grown 78% in four years. Third, erosion of premium fee pricing power through a rewards arms race, which would compress the net card fee stream of about USD 10bn.

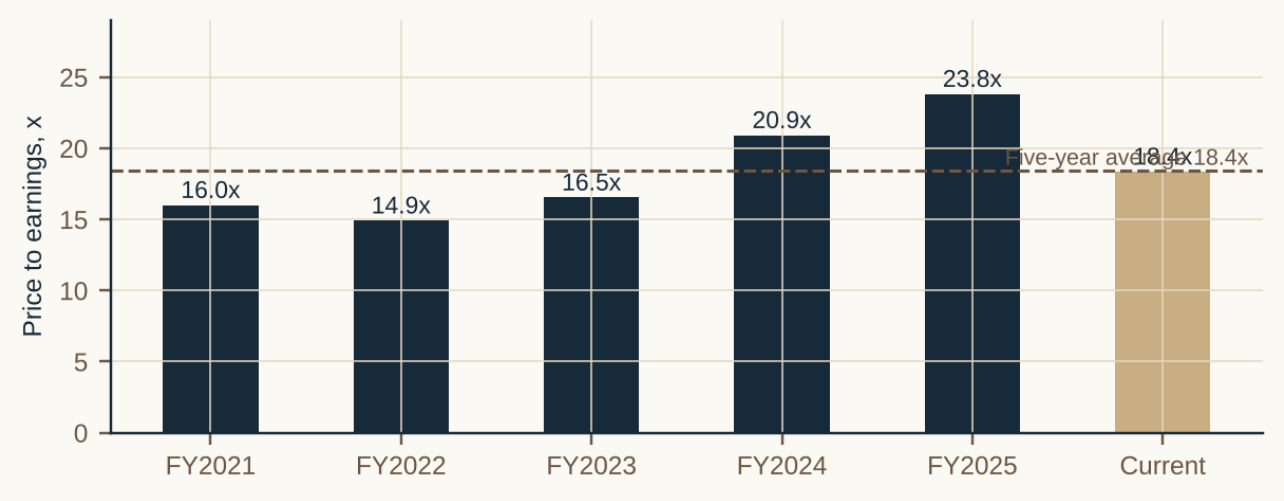
B3. Valuation

CURRENT VALUATION AT USD 325.50 (3 NOVEMBER 2026)

Multiple	Value	Basis
Price to earnings, trailing GAAP EPS of USD 17.73	18.4x	Calculated
Price to earnings, trailing adjusted EPS of USD 17.02	19.1x	Calculated, excludes USD 1.11 gain and restructuring
Price to earnings, FY2026 adjusted guidance midpoint USD 17.75	18.3x	Management guidance
Price to earnings, FY2026 GAAP guidance midpoint USD 18.45	17.6x	Management guidance
Forward price to earnings (provider consensus, 26 October)	16.3x	Market expectation
Price to free cash flow, trailing USD 13.9bn	15.7x	Calculated
Price to book (provider book value per share)	6.0x	Calculated
Price to sales, trailing revenue USD 77.6bn	2.8x	Calculated
Dividend yield (USD 3.80 annualized)	1.17%	Calculated
Free cash flow yield	6.4%	Calculated
Market capitalization and enterprise value	USD 218.3bn; USD 234.8bn	Calculated; provider net debt USD 16.5bn

Source: StockAnalysis.com statistics page (26 October 2026); American Express Form 8-K third quarter 2026; Alpha Vantage price series. Trailing GAAP EPS of USD 17.73 and adjusted EPS combine the first nine months of 2026 and the fourth quarter of 2025. Enterprise value and EV/EBITDA are not used for decision purposes because debt and deposits fund the loan book.

Price to earnings at fiscal year-end and current, FY2021 to November 2026



Source: StockAnalysis.com annual ratios; current multiple calculated at USD 325.50. Units: multiple of trailing GAAP earnings.

Historical valuation. The trailing multiple moved from 14.9 times at the end of FY2022 to 23.8 times at the end of FY2025, as earnings grew and the price rose. At 18.4 times, the stock sits at the five-year average of 18.4 times and 23% below the FY2025 year-end multiple. Peer valuation. The multiple is 45% below Visa (33.6 times) and Mastercard (33.4 times) and 53% above Capital One (12.0 times).

The pure networks command a premium because they carry no credit risk and earn 47% to 51% net margins; the discount to them is largely explained by the 15.8% net margin and the loan book, and the premium to Capital One by a return on equity of 35.9% against 9.4%. A low multiple does not make it cheap, and a premium does not make it expensive.

Cash-flow valuation. Section C5 values the equity with a distributable cash-flow model. The base case gives USD 273 per share and a range of USD 237 to USD 321 for a cost of equity of 9.0% to 11.0% at 3.0% terminal growth.

The current price of USD 325.50 is above the base case and requires one of two things: a cost of equity of about 8.9% with base growth, or earnings growth of about 13.4% a year for five years at a 10.0% cost of equity. Management guides revenue growth of about 10% and EPS has compounded at 11.3%, so the second condition is above both.

Market expectations therefore look reasonable to optimistic: the stock does not need heroics, but it leaves little margin for a credit or regulatory disappointment.

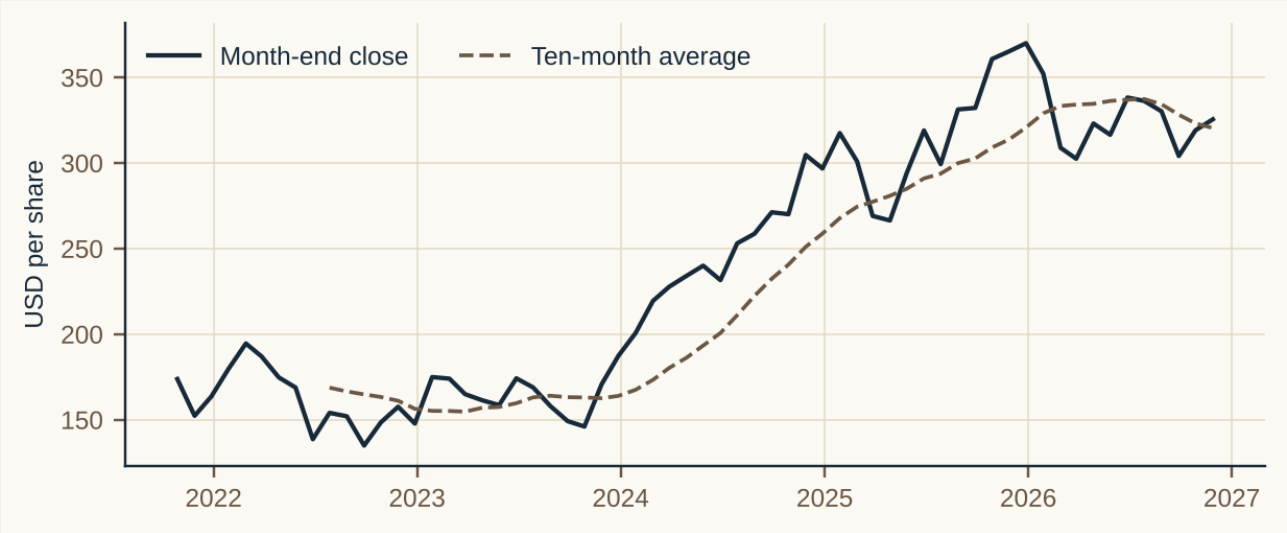
B4. Capital Market and Stock Analysis

PRICE PERFORMANCE TO 3 NOVEMBER 2026

Period	Price return	Total return	Basis
One day	minus 0.8%	Not retrieved	Daily closes
One week	4.0%	Not retrieved	Daily closes
One month	7.1%	Not retrieved	Daily closes (21 trading days)
Three months (12 June 2026)	0.0%	Not retrieved	Daily closes; S&P 500 ETF plus 1.7%
Six months (30 April)	0.8%	Not retrieved	Month-end closes
Year to date (31 December 2025)	minus 12.0%	Not retrieved	Month-end closes
One year (31 October 2025)	minus 9.8%	minus 8.8%	Month-end adjusted closes
Three years (31 October 2023)	122.9%	130.6%	32.1% annual total return
Five years (29 October 2021)	87.3%	99.2%	About 14.7% annual total return

Source: Alpha Vantage daily and monthly adjusted price series, NYSE, to 3 November 2026. Total return uses adjusted closes, which include dividends. Periods are measured from the nearest available month-end.

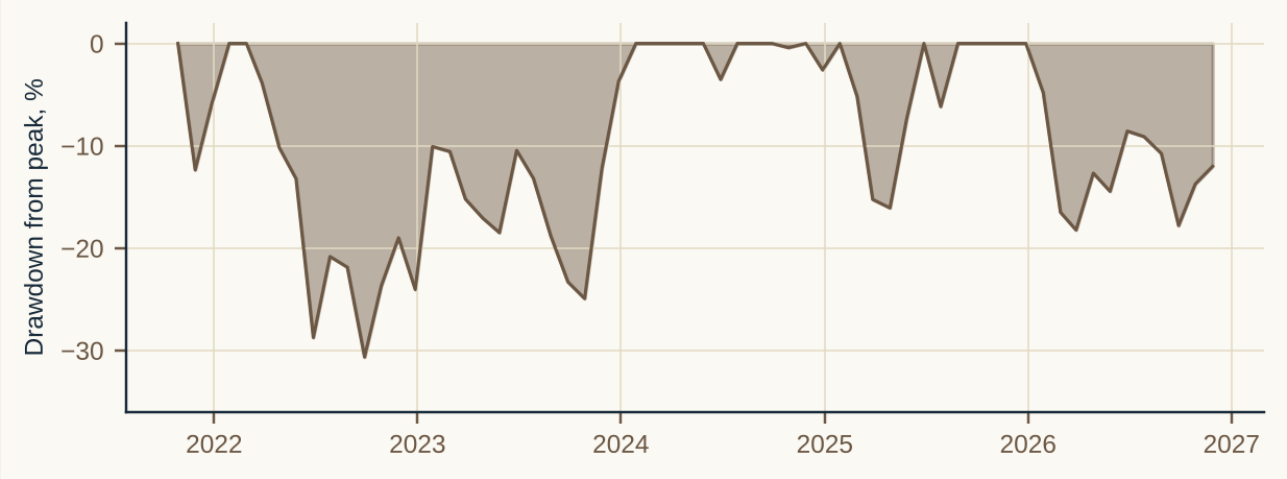
AXP month-end closing price with ten-month average, October 2021 to November 2026



Source: Alpha Vantage monthly price series, NYSE. Units: USD per share.

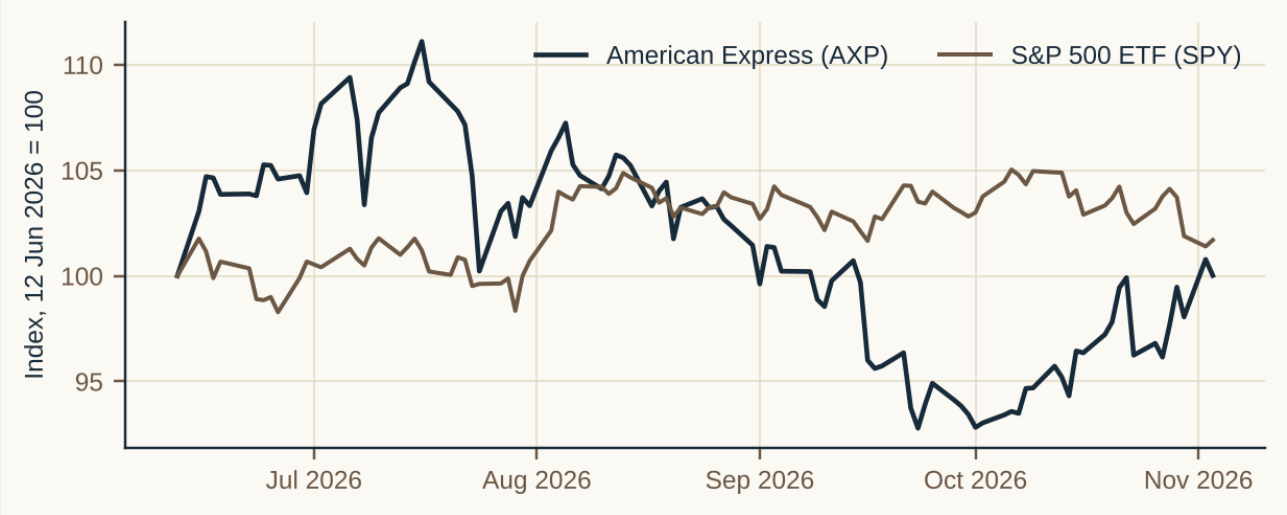
Trend and drawdowns. The stock rose from USD 173.78 at the end of October 2021 to a month-end high of USD 369.95 in December 2025, then fell 16.5% in two months to USD 308.90 at the end of February 2026 and to USD 302.48 in March. The deepest month-end drawdown in the five-year window was 30.7%, from February to September 2022, when the stock fell from USD 194.54 to USD 134.91. It regained the prior high in January 2024, about two years after the peak. The current drawdown from the December 2025 close is 12.0%.

Drawdown from running month-end peak, October 2021 to November 2026



Source: Alpha Vantage monthly price series, calculated. Units: percent below prior peak.

AXP against the S&P 500 ETF, rebased, 12 June to 3 November 2026



Source: Alpha Vantage daily price series, NYSE Arca for SPY. Units: index, starting value 100.

Relative performance. Over the 100-day window the stock was flat while the S&P 500 ETF gained 1.7%, and over twelve months the stock fell 9.8% while the ETF returned 11.1% in total. A sector benchmark was not retrieved, so relative performance versus the financial sector is not stated.

VOLATILITY AND RISK

Measure	Value	Basis
Annualized volatility, 100 trading days	23.3%	Calculated, daily log returns
Annualized volatility, five years	26.2%	Calculated, monthly adjusted returns
Downside volatility, 100 days and five years	17.3% and 16.7%	Calculated
Beta versus S&P 500 ETF, 100 days	0.74	Calculated
Beta, five-year provider figure	1.08	StockAnalysis.com
Correlation with S&P 500 ETF, 100 days	0.37	Calculated
Maximum drawdown, month-end five years	minus 30.7%	Calculated
Maximum drawdown, daily closes in 100 days	minus 16.5%	Calculated

Source: Alpha Vantage price series; StockAnalysis.com. The 100-day beta covers a period when the benchmark was unusually calm (annualized volatility 11.7%) and is lower than the five-year figure; the longer provider figure is the better guide to market sensitivity.

Technical structure. The close of USD 325.50 is above the 50-day average of USD 316.80 and just below the 200-day average of USD 326.97 reported by the data provider on 26 October. The 14-day relative strength index is 58.5, a neutral reading, and the MACD line (2.54) is above its signal line (0.96), which signals improving short-term momentum after a trough.

The 14-day average true range is USD 7.34, or 2.3% of price, so a normal daily move is about USD 7. Support sits near USD 302 to USD 305, where closing lows were set on 23 September and 1 October, and resistance sits in the USD 336 to USD 345 zone that capped the stock from July to August, then at the USD 361.57 closing high of July. The 52-week price change was minus 11.4% on 26 October.

Technicals describe sentiment and positioning; they say nothing about whether earnings justify the price, and the stock can be technically firm and still be fully valued.

C. Financial Statements

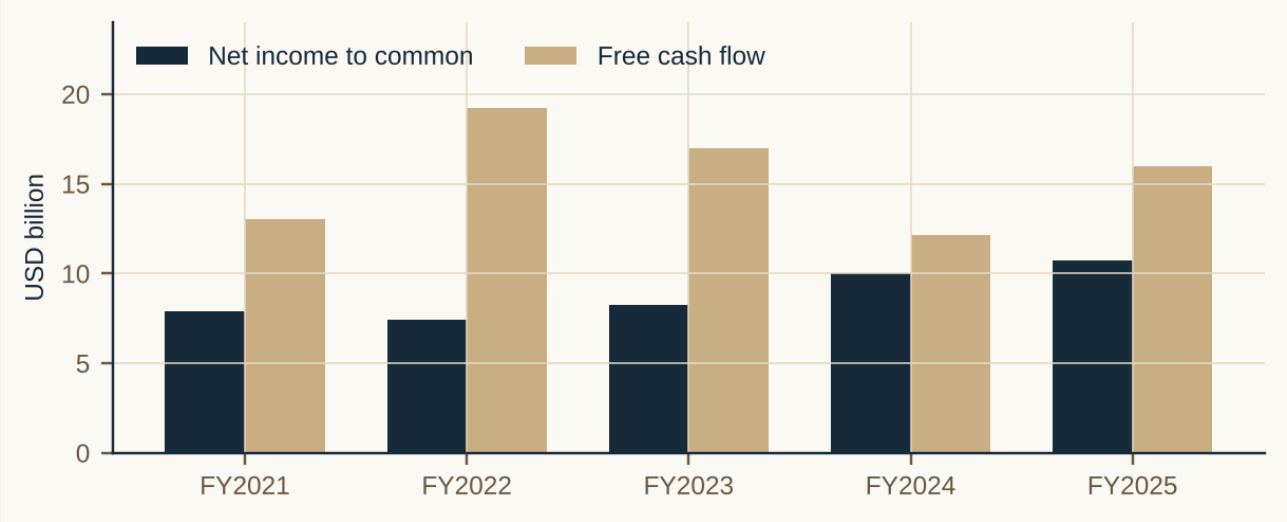
C1. Income Statement

INCOME STATEMENT SUMMARY, USD MILLION EXCEPT PER SHARE

Item	FY2021	FY2022	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025
Net revenue after provisions (derived)	43,799	50,680	55,592	60,764	66,973
Growth	n/a	15.7%	9.7%	9.3%	10.2%
Pretax income (derived)	10,687	9,584	10,512	12,894	13,796
Net income to common	7,917	7,400	8,252	9,995	10,701
Diluted EPS (USD)	10.02	9.85	11.21	14.01	15.38
Diluted shares, millions (derived)	790	751	736	713	696
Dividend per share (USD)	1.72	2.08	2.40	2.80	3.28
Total revenue net of interest expense (reported)	n/a	n/a	60,500	65,949	72,229
Net income (reported)	n/a	n/a	n/a	10,129	10,833

Source: StockAnalysis.com annual income statement; American Express Form 8-K January 2026 and annual report. Provider revenue equals reported revenue net of interest expense less provisions (FY2025: 72,229 minus about 5,260); FY2023 reported revenue is shown rounded as published. Provider net income is attributable to common shareholders and is lower than reported net income by preferred dividends and participating allocations.

Net income to common and free cash flow, FY2021 to FY2025



Source: StockAnalysis.com annual income statement and cash flow statement. Units: USD billion.

Drivers. FY2025 revenue net of interest expense rose 9.5% to USD 72.2bn (9% currency-adjusted) on billed business growth of 8% and net card fees near USD 10bn; volume and fees drove the growth rather than acquisitions. Provisions were USD 5.3bn against USD 5.2bn with a write-off rate of 2.0% unchanged. Total expenses rose 11% to USD 53.2bn, faster than revenue.

Operating leverage was therefore slightly negative before provisions, and the pretax margin on revenue after provisions slipped from 21.2% to 20.6%. EPS still grew 10%, helped by a 2% fall in the diluted share count and a stable 21.5% tax rate. FY2024 EPS of USD 14.01 included a USD 0.66 gain from the Accertify sale, so adjusted EPS growth in FY2025 was 15% from USD 13.35.

Third quarter of 2026. Revenue rose 9% to USD 20.1bn and billed business 8% to USD 454.0bn.

GAAP net income was USD 3.71bn (EPS USD 5.42), but it contained a USD 982m pretax gain on the GBTG stake and a USD 336m restructuring charge; adjusted EPS was USD 4.68, up 13%. Provisions fell 23% to USD 1.0bn because of a reserve

release against a build a year earlier, and the effective tax rate fell to 18.1% from 24.1%. Both of those favorable items are less repeatable than spending growth.

Management raised FY2026 guidance to adjusted EPS of USD 17.60 to 17.90 and GAAP EPS of USD 18.30 to 18.60 with revenue growth near 10%. Margins are broadly stable. The split of revenue growth into volume, price and mix, and the cost split between rewards, marketing and compensation, were not retrieved.

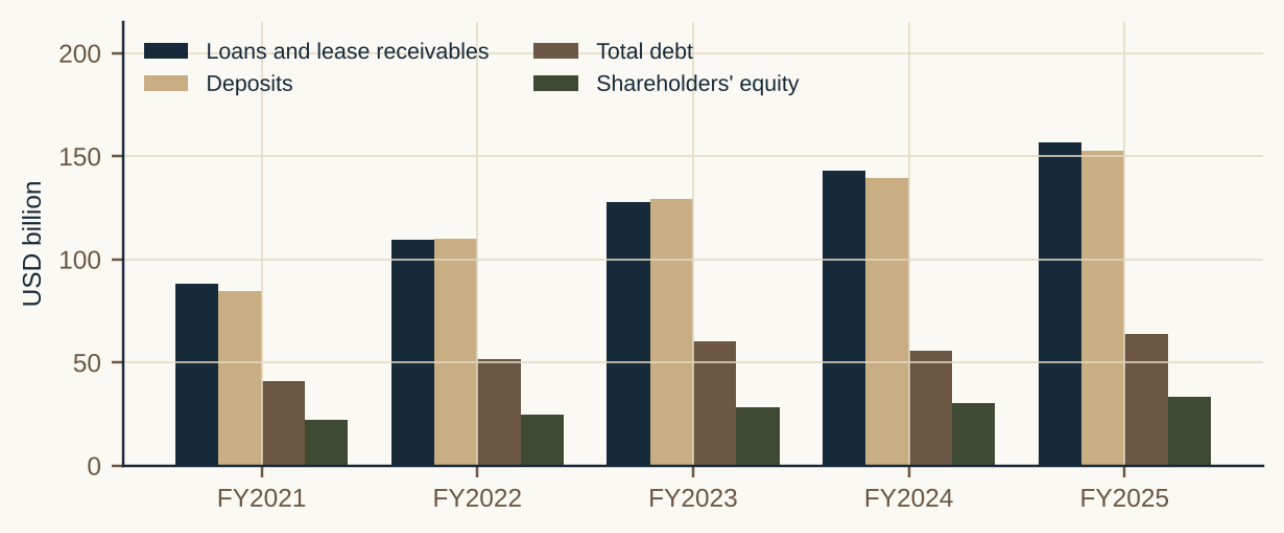
C2. Balance Sheet

BALANCE SHEET SUMMARY, USD MILLION AT YEAR-END

Item	FY2021	FY2022	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025
Cash and equivalents	21,040	33,052	46,082	40,213	47,623
Loans and lease receivables	88,116	109,574	127,837	143,033	156,528
Other receivables	53,581	57,384	60,237	59,240	61,851
Goodwill	3,804	3,786	3,851	4,187	4,872
Total assets	188,548	228,354	261,108	271,461	300,052
Total deposits	84,382	110,239	129,144	139,413	152,488
Total debt	40,960	51,605	59,982	55,500	63,909
Total liabilities	166,371	203,643	233,051	241,197	266,578
Shareholders' equity	22,177	24,711	28,057	30,264	33,474
Shares outstanding, millions	761	743	723	702	686
Equity to total assets	11.8%	10.8%	10.7%	11.1%	11.2%

Source: StockAnalysis.com annual balance sheet, accessed 4 November 2026; equity ratio calculated.

Loans, deposits, debt and equity, FY2021 to FY2025



Source: StockAnalysis.com annual balance sheet. Units: USD billion.

Balance-sheet strength. Assets grew 59% in four years to USD 300.1bn and loans grew 78%, while equity grew 51%, so leverage rose slightly from 8.5 times to 9.0 times assets to equity. Deposits fund 97% of loans, which is a stable and relatively cheap structure, and cash of USD 47.6bn covers 31% of deposits.

Regulatory capital requires a 7.0% CET1 ratio including the stress buffer; the actual ratio was not retrieved from the sources used. Goodwill of USD 4.9bn is 14.6% of equity, a moderate figure that rose 16% in FY2025. Total debt rose 15% in FY2025 to USD 63.9bn.

Red flags to watch are loan growth outrunning equity, a rising write-off rate on the new loan vintages, and funding costs if the ten-year yield, now 5.13%, keeps rising. Working capital, current ratio and quick ratio are not meaningful for a lender with an unclassified balance sheet. Off-balance-sheet obligations such as unused card credit lines were not retrieved.

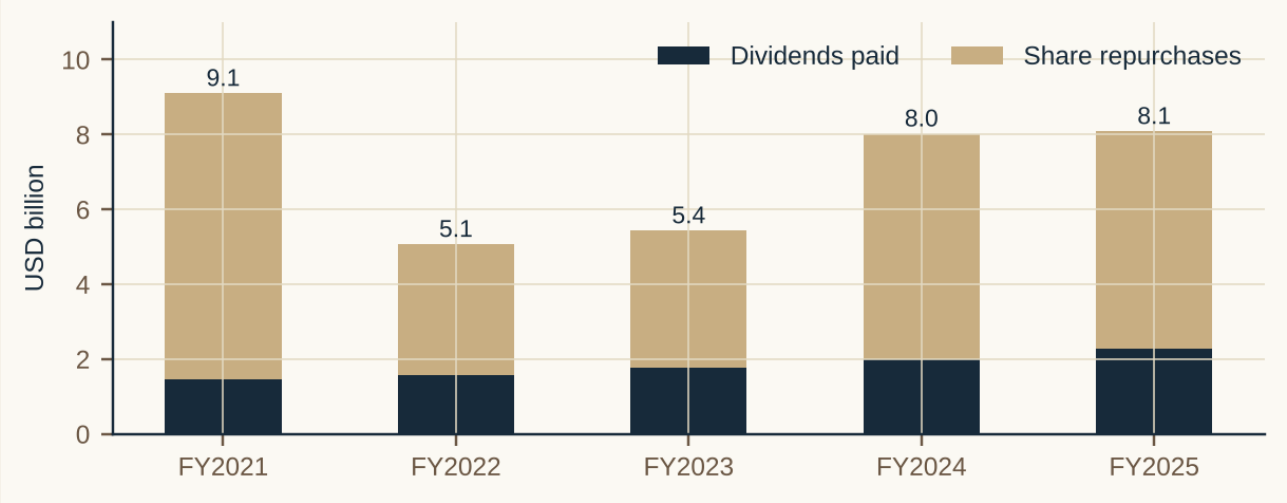
C3. Cash Flow Statement

CASH FLOW SUMMARY, USD MILLION

Item	FY2021	FY2022	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025
Operating cash flow	14,645	21,079	18,559	14,050	18,428
Capital expenditure	1,638	1,856	1,565	1,917	2,426
Free cash flow	13,007	19,223	16,994	12,133	16,002
Dividends paid	1,448	1,565	1,780	1,999	2,271
Share repurchases	7,652	3,502	3,650	6,020	5,814
Debt issued	8,249	23,230	15,674	12,809	24,377
Debt repaid	11,662	19,612	10,808	10,759	18,184
Free cash flow to net income to common	1.64x	2.60x	2.06x	1.21x	1.50x

Source: StockAnalysis.com annual cash flow statement, accessed 4 November 2026. Free cash flow is operating cash flow minus capital expenditure. Trailing twelve months to 30 September 2026: operating cash flow 17,626, capital expenditure 3,717, free cash flow 13,909, dividends 2,499, repurchases 6,704.

Dividends and share repurchases, FY2021 to FY2025



Source: StockAnalysis.com annual cash flow statement. Units: USD billion; labels show totals.

Free cash flow has exceeded net income in every year, by 1.2 to 2.6 times, but that is a feature of how a lender’s statement is built rather than superior earnings quality: credit loss provisions are expensed in earnings but are non-cash, and the cash outflow for new loans is classified in investing. The comparison of accounting earnings to cash should therefore be read with that caveat, and it is the trend that matters.

Free cash flow was flat across the period while net income grew 35%. Capex rose from 3.4% of revenue in FY2025 to 4.8% on a trailing basis (USD 3.7bn), reflecting technology, premium lounges and servicing investment; the maintenance and growth split was not retrieved. Net debt issuance was USD 6.2bn in FY2025, and the company returned USD 8.1bn through dividends and buybacks, which is 51% of free cash flow.

C4. Forecasting and Projections

Revenue. Billed business grew 8% in FY2025 and 9% over nine months of 2026, and guidance for FY2026 is revenue growth of about 10%. The base case assumes FY2026 revenue of USD 79.5bn, then growth fading from 8.5% to 6% by FY2031 as the base grows and penetration gains slow. Segment drivers are net card fees (price and member growth), discount revenue (billed business at about 8% growth) and net interest income (loan growth of 9% to 10%). Market share, versus the network peers, was not retrieved.

Margins. The base case holds the net margin close to 15% of revenue, with operating leverage on technology offset by rewards and marketing costs. Gross margin and SG&A efficiency are not defined for the company in the sources used. Working capital needs are governed by loan growth, which requires roughly USD 11 of equity per USD 100 of assets; capex is assumed near 4% of revenue.

SCENARIO ANALYSIS, FY2026E TO FY2031E

Case	Rev. FY26E	Rev. FY31E	Rev. CAGR	NI FY31E	NI CAGR	Net margin	USD/share
Bear	77.3	98.2	4.9%	14.2	3.7%	14.5%	207
Base	79.5	117.8	8.2%	17.5	7.7%	14.8%	273
Bull	79.5	125.6	9.6%	19.4	10.0%	15.5%	335

Source: analyst model. Revenue and net income in USD billion. FY2026E net income of USD 12.07bn is the adjusted guidance midpoint of USD 17.75 multiplied by 680 million diluted shares; the bear case starts 2% lower. USD per share is the distributable cash-flow value from section C5 at cost of equity of 10.5% (bear), 10.0% (base) and 9.5% (bull) with terminal growth of 2.5%, 3.0% and 3.5%.

SENSITIVITY OF BASE VALUE PER SHARE TO FIVE-YEAR EARNINGS GROWTH, USD

Cost of equity	5%	7%	9%	11%	13%
9.0%	293	313	335	358	383
10.0%	250	267	284	302	322
11.0%	218	232	246	261	277

Source: analyst model. Columns show uniform annual net income growth for FY2027E to FY2031E; return on equity 30%, terminal growth 3.0%.

C5. Discounted Cash Flow (DCF) Model

Because American Express is a lender, a conventional enterprise DCF would treat deposits and debt as financing when they are really inventory. The model therefore values the equity directly. Distributable cash flow in each year is net income minus the retention required to grow the balance sheet, which is the growth rate divided by the return on equity (30% in the explicit period, a haircut to the 34.0% reported, and 25% in the terminal year).

BASE CASE ASSUMPTIONS

Assumption	Value and basis
Starting earnings	FY2026E net income USD 12.07bn: adjusted guidance midpoint USD 17.75 on 680 million diluted shares
Revenue assumption	USD 79.5bn in FY2026E (about 10% growth), then 8.5%, 8.0%, 7.5%, 7.0%, 6.0%
Net income growth, FY2027E to FY2031E	9.0%, 8.5%, 8.0%, 7.0%, 6.0%
Margin assumption	Net income about 15% of revenue
Tax rate	21.5% as in FY2024 and FY2025, embedded in net income
Capex and working capital	Capex about 4% of revenue, working capital through loan growth funded by retention
Cost of equity (discount rate)	10.0%: risk-free 5.13% (ten-year Treasury, October 2026) plus beta 1.08 times 4.5% equity risk premium, rounded
Terminal growth	3.0% with terminal return on equity of 25%
Terminal value	USD 140.6bn present value, 77% of equity value
Net debt and shares	Not used directly; equity value divided by 670.55 million shares outstanding
Equity value and range	USD 183bn base, USD 273 per share; USD 237 to USD 321 for 9% to 11% cost of equity

Source: analyst model using American Express guidance, StockAnalysis.com statistics and Alpha Vantage Treasury yield data. The equity risk premium is an analyst assumption.

SENSITIVITY: COST OF EQUITY (ROWS) AGAINST TERMINAL GROWTH (COLUMNS), VALUE PER SHARE IN USD

Cost of equity	2.0%	2.5%	3.0%	3.5%	4.0%
8.5%	317	333	352	375	403
9.0%	293	306	321	340	361
9.5%	272	283	295	310	328
10.0%	254	263	273	285	299
10.5%	237	245	254	264	275
11.0%	223	230	237	246	255
11.5%	211	216	222	229	237

The result is a range, not a point estimate. Bear, base and bull cases give about USD 207, USD 273 and USD 335 per share. The USD 325.50 market price sits inside the range only for a cost of equity near 9% or lower, or growth near the bull case. Terminal value is 77% of the total, so small changes in the discount rate dominate. Stock-based compensation is included in reported net income.

C6. Leveraged Buyout (LBO) Model

Not applicable. American Express is a regulated bank holding company with a market capitalization of USD 218bn, deposit-funded assets, and capital rules that limit distributions, so a leveraged buyout is not a meaningful framework.

D. Investment Thesis

Bull Case

Revenue growth stays at 10% to 11% through FY2028 as billed business compounds near 9% and net card fees keep rising, while operating leverage lifts the net margin from 15.2% to 15.5%. Market share gains in commercial payments and in international cards add to growth, and capital return of about USD 8bn a year cuts the share count further. Net income reaches about USD 19.4bn by FY2031E, and the market assigns a lower cost of equity of about 9.5%. Under these assumptions the equity cash-flow value is about USD 335 per share.

Bear Case

Growth slows to 4% to 6% as consumer spending weakens, credit costs rise above the 2.0% write-off rate on a loan book that has grown 78% in four years, and rewards spending climbs to defend share. Margin falls from 15.3% to about 14.5%. Regulation or competition lowers fee income, funding costs rise with the ten-year yield at 5.13%, and the multiple contracts toward the 14.9 times seen at the end of FY2022. The equity cash-flow value is about USD 207 per share.

Base Case

Revenue grows about 10% in FY2026 and fades to 6% by FY2031, net income grows 9% to 6% with a stable net margin near 15%, the write-off rate stays near 2%, and about USD 8bn a year is returned to holders. A multiple of 16 to 18 times earnings is consistent with that profile. The equity cash-flow value is about USD 273 per share, below the market price, so the base case does not by itself show an obvious discount.

Catalysts

POTENTIAL CATALYSTS

Event	Timing	Why it matters
Fourth quarter and FY2026 results	Early 2027	Tests the raised guidance of USD 17.60 to 17.90 adjusted EPS
FY2027 guidance	Early 2027	Sets growth and expense expectations; first view of reserve policy
Quarterly dividend and buybacks	Each quarter	Dividend rose 16% to USD 0.95; repurchases of USD 6.7bn trailing
Fee changes on premium cards	Ongoing	Net card fees near USD 10bn drive recurring revenue
Legislation on routing and interest rates	Uncertain	Can change merchant and lending economics
Restructuring benefits	FY2027	USD 336m charge in the third quarter of 2026 should lower costs

Source: American Express Form 8-K third quarter 2026 and analyst assessment. Event dates other than the reporting cycle are not confirmed.

Things to Monitor

MONITORING LIST

Metric or event	Why it matters	Positive	Negative
Net write-off rate	Credit loss drives earnings	At or below 2.0%	Above 2.5%
Billed business growth	Volume drives discount revenue	8% or higher	Below 5%
Expense growth against revenue	Operating leverage	Expenses grow slower than revenue	Expenses outgrow revenue as in FY2025
Reserve releases	Quality of earnings	Earnings without releases	Earnings that depend on releases
Loan growth against deposits	Funding and risk	Deposits cover 95% or more of loans	Coverage below 90%
Ten-year Treasury yield	Funding cost and valuation	Below 4.5%	Above 5.5%
Legislation	Fee and rate structure	No enactment	Routing or rate caps passed

Thresholds are analyst judgments, not company targets.

E. Final Investment Framework

BUSINESS QUALITY	High. A premium base, closed-loop data and about USD 10bn of annual fees support a 34.0% return on equity.
FINANCIAL QUALITY	High with caveats. Free cash flow of USD 16.0bn exceeds net income of USD 10.8bn, but lender cash flow includes non-cash provisions and loan growth is funded by debt and deposits.
COMPETITIVE POSITION	Strong but narrow. Fourth largest general-purpose network, a moat assessed as Moderate to Strong.
MANAGEMENT	Capable and shareholder oriented. Long-tenured chief executive, share count down 2.6% a year, dividend up 16%. FY2025 expenses grew faster than revenue.
INDUSTRY	Mature with structural growth. Card penetration rises, while consolidation, technology and regulation reshape economics.
VALUATION	Fair to full. 18.4 times earnings at the five-year average, base equity cash-flow value of USD 273 against a USD 325.50 price.
TECHNICAL AND MARKET STRUCTURE	Neutral. Above the 50-day average, just below the 200-day average, relative strength 58.5, draw-down of 12.0% from the high, and trailing the market over twelve months.
PRINCIPAL RISK	Regulation of merchant fees and interest rates, or a credit cycle on a loan book up 78% in four years.
PRINCIPAL CATALYST	FY2026 results and FY2027 guidance in early 2027 against raised guidance.
KEY VARIABLE	The net write-off rate, currently 1.8% to 2.0%, because each point is worth about USD 1.6bn of pretax income.
THESIS INVALIDATION	The investment thesis would become materially weaker if the net write-off rate stays above 2.5% for two consecutive quarters, if billed business growth falls below 5%, if legislation caps card interest rates or mandates merchant routing, or if return on equity falls below 28%.

F. Data Table

Category	Metric	Current	Prior year	3Y / 5Y trend
Market	Market capitalization	USD 218.3bn	USD 209.1bn (FY2024 end)	USD 126.7bn (FY2021 end)
Market	Enterprise value	USD 234.8bn	Not retrieved	Not meaningful for a lender
Market	Share price	USD 325.50	USD 360.73 (31 Oct 2025)	Plus 87.3% in five years
Growth	Net revenue growth after provisions	10.2% (FY2025)	9.3% (FY2024)	11.2% CAGR, four years
Profitability	Gross margin	Not applicable	Not applicable	Not applicable
Profitability	Pretax margin on net revenue after provisions	20.6%	21.2%	18.9% to 24.4%
Profitability	Net margin to common	16.0%	16.4%	14.6% to 18.1%
Profitability	ROE	34.0%	34.7%	31.7% to 35.7%
Profitability	ROIC	11.7%	11.2%	10.4% to 11.7%
Cash flow	Operating cash flow	USD 18.4bn	USD 14.1bn	5.9% CAGR, four years
Cash flow	Free cash flow	USD 16.0bn	USD 12.1bn	5.3% CAGR, four years
Leverage	Net debt / EBITDA	Not meaningful	Not meaningful	Assets to equity 8.5x to 9.0x
Valuation	P/E	18.4x	23.8x (FY2025 end)	Average 18.4x
Valuation	EV/EBITDA	Not meaningful	Not meaningful	Not meaningful
Valuation	P/FCF	15.7x	15.9x (FY2025 end)	5.7x to 17.2x
Market	Beta	1.08 (five-year)	Not retrieved	0.74 over 100 days
Market	Volatility	23.3% (100 days)	Not retrieved	26.2% (five years)
Market	Maximum drawdown	Minus 16.5% (100 days)	Not retrieved	Minus 30.7% (five years)

Source: StockAnalysis.com; American Express filings; Alpha Vantage price series; analyst calculations. Current figures are as of 3 November 2026 or the latest fiscal year, FY2025.

G. Sources and Methodology

Data cross-check

Reported and provider figures were compared before use. Net income for FY2025 is USD 10,833m in the company release and USD 10,701m in the provider series, which is net income attributable to common shareholders after preferred dividends and participating allocations; EPS of USD 15.38 agrees in both, so the company figure is used for headline net income and the provider series for the five-year trend.

Revenue of USD 72.2bn in the company release differs from the provider figure of USD 67.0bn, but the difference equals reported provisions of about USD 5.3bn, and the segment total of USD 67.0bn is also after provisions. Shareholder returns are USD 7.6bn in the annual report and USD 8.1bn in the cash flow statement; the cash flow figure is used in tables and the annual report figure is quoted for management’s framing.

Beta is 1.08 from a five-year provider measure and 0.74 on 100 days; the five-year figure is preferred. Forward earnings of 16.3 times (provider consensus at USD 316.08) compare with 18.3 times on adjusted management guidance at USD 325.50; the guidance-based figure is shown beside the consensus figure.

Market capitalization is recomputed at the 3 November close using 670.55 million shares, giving USD 218.3bn against the provider’s USD 211.95bn at USD 316.08. Dates across peer pages range from 26 October to 1 November 2026. The segment totals, regional revenue, CET1 ratio, net interest income split, expense split and executive biographies were partly not retrieved and are marked as such.

Source list

Primary Sources

American Express Company, Form 8-K, Exhibit 99.1, third quarter 2026 earnings release. October 2026. https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/0000004962/000000496226000405/q326exhibit991.htm. Information obtained: Third quarter and nine-month 2026 revenue, net income, EPS, provisions, billed business, non-GAAP adjustments and FY2026 guidance

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Market Data

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Calculations

Calculated by the analyst: market capitalization at the 3 November close (price times 670.55 million shares), trailing multiples, free cash flow (operating cash flow minus capital expenditure), pretax income and margins on revenue after provisions, growth rates and CAGRs, holding period returns from month-end and daily closes, annualized volatility (daily log-return standard deviation times the square root of 252, monthly times the square root of 12), downside volatility, beta (covariance with the S&P 500 ETF over variance), maximum drawdown, 50-day average, relative strength index, MACD, average true range, and the equity cash-flow valuation in section C5.

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